

49 Quantifiers

A Sample sentences

If you have no customer feedback, it is very difficult to understand their needs. That's where qualitative research comes in. It has many common uses. It can help you to understand why some customers buy and use a product. It can also investigate a lot of alternative communication messages. Most of our clients use our services to understand their customers better. And all of them use this information in the development of new products.

B Form

Countable	all	most	many	a lot of	some	a few	few	no
Uncountable	all	most	much	a lot of	some	a little	little	no

We use *countable quantifiers* with *plural countable nouns*; we use *uncountable quantifiers* with *uncountable nouns*. ➔ 44

Qualitative market research has **many** common uses.
[quantifier] [countable noun]

If you have **no** customer feedback, it is difficult to understand their needs.
[quantifier] [uncountable noun]

C Uses

Below are some examples of *quantifiers* in use, first in a short dialogue and then in an extract from a presentation.

- A: Is there much demand for civil engineers these days?
 B: You wouldn't believe it, but most of the vacancies are for civil engineers.
 A: Really? With what type of qualifications?
 B: All our vacancies require people with a thorough knowledge of surveying.
 A: Don't most civil engineers need to know about surveying?
 B: Yes, but there are some jobs in areas not directly linked to construction.
 A: Such as?
 B: We have a few vacancies for engineers to work in the aircraft industry.
 A: Anything in nuclear power?
 B: No vacancies in that area at the moment, I'm afraid.
 A: Well, please let me know if anything turns up.

In *all* turnkey contracts we undertake to finance, design, specify, construct, and commission the whole project. As *many of* our clients ask for a follow-up maintenance agreement, *most* maintenance will be included in the project price. However, there are *some* repairs which will not be covered. But, I wish to assure you that in other contracts there have been very *few* of these.

1 Put the following in order from the most to the least.

- 1 Some of our clothing is made of silk.
- 2 None of our clothing is made of silk.
- 3 Most of our clothing is made of silk.
- 4 Little of our clothing is made of silk.
- 5 Much of our clothing is made of silk.
- 6 A lot of our clothing is made of silk.
- 7 A little of our clothing is made of silk.
- 8 All of our clothing is made of silk.

2 Complete the sentences with the words given in brackets.

- 1 There aren't _____ people working at night. _____ of the staff work during the day. (most, many)
- 2 _____ of the timber which was delivered last week was of very poor quality. We had to return _____ of the boards. (a few, some)
- 3 We don't manufacture _____ jackets of pure wool. There isn't _____ demand for them. (many, much)
- 4 Fibre optic cabling will be used in the future for _____ land-based communications. But, today, only _____ of these communications use fibre optics. (all, some)
- 5 At present, only a _____ paper is recycled in the UK. In the future, a _____ more paper will have to be collected and recycled. (little, lot)
- 6 In the UK, _____ electricity is generated from nuclear energy or fossil fuels and very _____ renewable energy sources have so far been developed. (few, most)

3 The table below shows how the methods of transportation used by a company have changed over a period of 30 years. Complete the text below with words from the table in B on the opposite page.

Year	1970	1980	1990	2000	2010
rail	100%	85%	60%	40%	0%
road	0%	12%	35%	40%	70%
air	0%	3%	5%	20%	30%

In 1970 (a) all transportation was carried out by rail. (b) _____ goods were carried by road or by air. Ten years later, (c) _____ goods were transported by rail and a (d) _____ were taken by road. For the first time goods were being transported by air but there weren't (e) _____ goods being transported in this way. In 1990 the picture had changed. A (f) _____ goods were still being transported by rail. However, (g) _____ more transportation was by road and a (h) _____ transportation was being done by air. By the year 2000, (i) _____ transportation was by rail, (j) _____ by road and a (k) _____ was by air. By the year 2010, it is expected that (l) _____ goods will be transported by rail. (m) _____ goods will be transported by road and (n) _____ will be taken by air.